

World

- One year after the 2025 India–Pakistan conflict — which left dozens dead and briefly threatened nuclear escalation — the ceasefire is holding and commercial flights have resumed, but diplomatic normalization remains frozen. India is now reportedly preparing a test-fire of its Agni-6 ballistic missile (range up to 10,000 km), raising fresh stability concerns a year after Trump's Kashmir mediation claims complicated Modi's posture. ([Washington Post](#), [Manila Times](#))
- The US-Iran conflict has effectively closed the Strait of Hormuz, trapping a significant portion of the world's oil supply and causing fuel and fertilizer prices to spike globally. Economists warn the disrupted chokepoint is rippling through agricultural supply chains well beyond the Middle East, with food prices rising in import-dependent nations. ([NPR](#))
- President Trump set a July 4 deadline for the EU to ratify their bilateral trade agreement, threatening "much higher" tariffs if Brussels does not comply. The ultimatum followed Trump's announcement of 25% tariffs on EU car and truck imports, accusing Europe of non-compliance with a deal struck at his Scottish golf resort last July. EU officials have pushed back, calling the deadline coercive. ([CNBC](#), [Al Jazeera](#))
- EU–China tensions are escalating as Europe grapples with surging Chinese industrial overcapacity across steel, EVs, and electronics — even as the continent's fragmented political will limits its ability to coordinate a unified response. Analysts describe the dynamic as structural and worsening. ([Lazard Geopolitical Outlook](#))

US & Politics

- The US Court of International Trade struck down a second round of Trump's global tariffs on May 7, ruling that replacement taxes — imposed after the Supreme Court's February decision that the original tariffs exceeded presidential authority — also lack legal basis. The government must now refund over \$166 billion in collected duties, with first payments expected next week. The ruling deepens uncertainty over the administration's trade strategy heading into midterms. ([NPR](#), [KPBS](#))
- Special elections in Indiana, Ohio, and Michigan on May 5 showed Democrats continuing to outperform expectations ahead of November midterms. In Indiana, Trump backed primary challengers against seven state senators who opposed his redistricting plan and won five; but in Michigan, a Democrat won a key bellwether state Senate district — the latest in a string of Democratic special-election victories that polls show is powered by an enthusiasm gap. ([PBS NewsHour](#))
- Republicans have enacted new congressional maps in five states targeting 13 Democratic-held US House seats, while Democratic-favoring maps in California, Utah, and Virginia could flip as many as 10 seats the other way. A Washington Post–ABC poll finds 73% of Democrats say this election cycle is more important than past midterms, compared to just 52% of Republicans — a 21-point enthusiasm gap. ([CNN](#), [CNN](#))
- House Republicans failed to pass a resolution extending a prohibition on Congress canceling Trump's tariff authority, after three GOP members — including Rep. Don Bacon — broke ranks, arguing the Constitution assigns tariff authority to the legislative branch. ([Tax Foundation](#))

Tech & AI

- Apple plans to turn iOS 27 into an AI model marketplace. A new feature called "Extensions," arriving this fall, will let users route Siri, Writing Tools, Image Playground, and other Apple Intelligence features to third-party AI providers — including Google and Anthropic — through a new Settings option. Since iOS 18, ChatGPT has held the only third-party slot; under Extensions, it becomes one option among many across Apple's 2-billion-device install base. ([Bloomberg](#), [TechCrunch](#), [9to5Mac](#))
- Apple is in talks with Intel and Samsung as alternate chip suppliers for future processors — a notable shift for a company that tightly controlled its silicon roadmap since the Apple Silicon transition. Bloomberg reports the move is being driven by AI data center demand and stronger-than-expected Mac sales tied to on-device AI workloads. ([Bloomberg](#))
- Apple has quietly disbanded the core Vision Pro development team, with members reassigned to other projects. The move signals a strategic retreat from the \$3,499 spatial computing device following slow consumer adoption and a thin software ecosystem. The decision does not appear to indicate a successor device is in the pipeline. ([Hackaday](#))

Faith & Theology

- Christians living in Israel and Jerusalem are reporting a sharp increase in harassment and violence — 31 documented incidents in the first three months of 2026 alone, including spitting, physical assault, and defacing of church property. Community leaders say the incidents are becoming normalized alongside Israel's political shift toward far-right nationalism, creating a chilling effect on the roughly 10,000 Christians in East Jerusalem and 180,000 across Israel. ([Al Jazeera](#))

- Secretary of State Rubio met with Pope Leo XIV on May 7, making religious freedom and the global persecution of Christians a central topic — the first formal high-level exchange between the Trump administration and the new pontiff. No joint statement was released; readouts from each side emphasized shared concern for persecuted Christian minorities. ([Christianity Today](#)) (commentary)

■ San Diego

- Jacaranda on 9th, an 88-unit affordable housing development in downtown San Diego, held its grand opening on May 7. Most units serve households earning below 25% of area median income, with 14 units reserved for formerly homeless residents. The project is part of Mayor Gloria's housing push, even as the city grapples with a separate budget crisis. ([KPBS](#))
- Mayor Todd Gloria's proposed FY2027 budget, which closes a \$118 million general fund deficit, would eliminate a specialized multimodal traffic safety engineering team, cut library and recreation center hours, and freeze arts and cultural grants. The City Council pushed back sharply at a May 6 budget hearing; dozens of arts organizations appeared to protest the proposed grant freeze. ([KPBS](#), [KPBS](#))
- KPBS launched an interactive budget simulator letting San Diegans allocate cuts across city departments to close the \$118M gap — a civic engagement tool as budget negotiations intensify ahead of the June 15 deadline. ([KPBS](#))

■ Maker & Creative Economy

- Colossal profiles illustrator Fatinha Ramos, whose densely layered images blend portraiture, texture, and political charge under what she calls "visual activism." Her work uses the personal and the ornamental as tools of critique — intimate in scale, confrontational in intent. ([Colossal](#))
- Ceramicist Maxwell Mustardo sculpts works that evoke ancient Greek amphorae and kraters in brilliant glazed forms — archaic silhouettes made strange through organic surface texture and color. Colossal documents his labor-intensive studio practice and the months-long process behind each vessel. ([Colossal](#))
- Colossal reports on a week-long residency that brought nearly 80 international artists to an uninhabited island in Menorca — no audience, no deliverables, only collaborative work across disciplines. The piece examines what making looks like when stripped of commercial pressure and public accountability. ([Colossal](#))
- Hackaday's May 3 links roundup spotlights a fully functional quadruped robot dog built as a university senior project, and floats a reader challenge: show hacks powered entirely by ambient environmental energy — solar, kinetic, thermal. ([Hackaday](#))

■ Filmmaking Gear

- The FCC is accepting public comments through May 11 on whether to grant DJI's appeal of its Covered List designation — the federal designation that bans its products from US government use and has created broader market uncertainty. Working cinematographers who depend on DJI Ronin rigs and drones are specifically encouraged to submit comments documenting professional impact; the outcome could affect long-term US availability of DJI gear. ([Newsshooter](#))
- Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey* — starring Matt Damon as Odysseus alongside Anne Hathaway, Tom Holland, Robert Pattinson, Zendaya, and Lupita Nyong'o — released an official IMAX trailer. Shot on large-format film, the production is being watched closely by cinematographers as another showcase for Nolan's practical-first, IMAX-native pipeline. ([Newsshooter](#))
- Sony FX6 Firmware v6.0, released in March 2026, introduced the BIG6 shooting interface (inherited from VENICE/BURANO) and Blackmagic RAW recording over HDMI when paired with a Blackmagic Video Assist. The update is generating ongoing discussion among FX6 operators as a substantial quality-of-life upgrade for run-and-gun and documentary work. *Note: firmware released March 2026; included as ongoing coverage item.* ([Y.M.Cinema](#), [No Film School](#))

■ Electric Vehicles

- Volkswagen is skipping the ID.Buzz's 2026 model year in the US, choosing to sell down existing 2025 inventory before introducing the 2027 model later this year. The retro-styled electric van — currently the only fully electric minivan on sale in the US in meaningful numbers — got off to a slow start at \$61,545 for just 234 miles of range. VW's US CEO also confirmed that the company is in talks about bringing the camper version of the ID.Buzz to American buyers. ([InsideEVs](#))
- Ford's previously secret EV unit has unveiled a "Universal Electric Vehicle" (UEV) modular platform from its Long Beach, California, facility — designed to underpin a range of future vehicles including trucks and commercial platforms. Ford is betting the flexible architecture will help its Model e division move from billions in annual losses toward breakeven by 2029. ([CNBC](#))

- With Middle East tensions pushing fuel prices toward record highs, used EV economics are increasingly favorable for frequent drivers. A CNBC analysis finds energy savings now clearly tip in EVs' favor against gas vehicles, though insurance costs and depreciation remain significant variables for buyers weighing the switch. ([CNBC](#)) (*general EV news*)

■ Mito Research

- A case report published May 1 in *Medicine* documents twin brothers with MELAS carrying the m.3243A>G mutation who developed strikingly different clinical trajectories despite identical genetics — one with seizures and cognitive difficulties from age 10, the other with hearing loss followed by epilepsy at 12. Their mother is an asymptomatic carrier at ~31% heteroplasmy, underscoring how dramatically heteroplasmy level and tissue distribution shape phenotype. The paper discusses anticonvulsant management during status epilepticus and the mitochondrial supplement protocol used (coenzyme Q10, L-arginine, levetiracetam, ATP disodium), and calls for early genetic testing and family screening in suspected mitochondrial disease. ([Medicine — PubMed, May 1, 2026](#))

"The task of pastoral care is not to provide answers to the questions that suffering raises, but to provide a presence that enables people to live faithfully with unanswered questions."

— John Swinton, *Raging with Compassion: Pastoral Responses to the Problem of Evil*